



46 39 Coolest Mobile Phones



75 Open Source Apps, CS3, PowerPoint Tips



88 Onboard's Awful!

Digital Tools

Technology For Personal And SoHo Productivity

Lead Feature

ON THE LOT

All the gear you need to make your first open source movie

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It's no coincidence that this article shares its title with one of TV's most popular (and you must admit, inspiring) reality shows. Eventually, if it hasn't already, the thought of your own movie will pop into your head... "What will it be about? Who will I cast? *How* will I get it done?"

We can't help you with the first two questions—you're going to have to figure out that for yourself—but we can give you a friendly nod in the right direction for the third.

But First...

What, you might well ask, is an open source movie? The concept has two interpretations: the first is that an open source movie, like open source software, is available not only in its final, finished form, but also as a collection of raw footage and soundtracks, so anyone can make their own version of the movie using the same material. The second interpretation doesn't need the movie's source footage to be available, but slaps on the requirement that the movie be made only with open source software. It should then be released under an appropriate Creative Commons License (the Attribution-NoDerivatives-NonCommercial license seems to be the popular one). Of course, you can still make the source files for your movie available to the general public, and they might thank you for it.

How you release your movie is your decision; we're here to tell you about the best open

• Producer • Director
• Writer • Cinematographer
• Art Director • Editor